During the stay, Babur sent out the foragers who brought herds of sheep and cattle, from villages in the plain. They brought white cloths, aromatic roots, sugars, *tīpūchāqs*, and horses bred for trade from the Afghān traders they met on the roads.

Mindī Moghūl (Babur's military general) unhorsed Khwāja Khiẓr Lūhānī, a well-known and respected Afghān merchant. He beheaded him and brought his head to Babur. But it was not all rosy on the side of Babur's camp. Sherīm ṭaghāī faced an Afghān while following the foragers on the road and later chopped his index finger.

Return to Kābul

Babur had heard of two roads leading to Farmūl. One was Tunnel-rock (*Sang-i-sūrākh*) road, passing Birk (*Barak*) and the other was along Gūmāl but without touching Birk (Barak).

It rained relentlessly during their stay in the plain, and the river Gūmāl had swollen way beyond its natural width. It would have been very difficult to cross at the ford, where they had reached. Several people well-acquainted with the roads had appraised Babur that while going by the Gūmāl road, he would need to cross this torrent several times—a task that was seemingly impossible when the waters rose. Babur was unable to decide which road to choose. Babur instructed people to rest, hoping the water level would go down the next day. The drum of departure was loud enough to wake Babur and his men wake up from their slumber. Yet, things did not seem as good as they should have to Babur.

It was the 'Īd-al-fitr, the seventh day of the March in AD 1505. While Babur was engaged in the ablutions to break the fast, Jahāngīr Mīrzā and the begs discussed which road was to be taken. Someone suggested that if they were to turn at the last spur of the Mehtar Sulaimān range, they would get a level road though it might take a few more marches. Babur, when informed, chose to stick with this plan. A lot could have been finished before Babur's ablutions for Īd—his army had already taken the road and most of them had crossed Gūmāl. No one from Babur's side had ever seen that road. Certainly, no one was aware of the exact length of the road. Babur began his journey on this road without giving any second thought—he had decided to trust the hearsay about the route.

They read the 'Id prayer on the bank of river Gūmāl. That Persian New Year's Day, *Nūroz*, occurred close to the 'Id-al-fitr. And when only a few days were left for it to come, Babur composed the following (Turkī) sonnet:[*]